Project Shield Our Elders

Brevard County, Florida

Scam safety guide

Pause. Verify. Protect.

A guide for checking unexpected calls, messages, pop-ups, and QR codes.

- ## Pause before responding

  If a caller or message asks you to act quickly, keep a secret, or help a relative in an unexpected emergency, end the conversation while you check the story.

- ## Check who is contacting you

  Call the number on your bank card or statement, or a saved family number, instead of using contact details in the message. Caller ID and familiar voices can be faked.

- ## Keep your information private

  Do not share passwords, one-time codes, bank details, Social Security or Medicare numbers with an unexpected caller, or let them control your device. Avoid requests for gift cards, crypto, wires, payment apps, or transfers to a “safe account.”

If you already paid or shared information

If money was sent, call the bank or payment company right away and ask about stopping or reversing it. For a shared password or code, contact the account provider; for device access, use another safe device and get trusted tech help.

Keep messages and receipts, and ask someone you trust for help. Report a scam at ReportFraud.ftc.gov or 1-866-966-7226 (Florida). Avoid anyone charging to recover your money.

Trusted contact _____

Phone _____